

Prepare Level 3 on Your Own Computer

Document: Prepare Level 3 on Your Own Computer
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SHA256: bf54ebb445f4da677c44964821cfbde20ae54204bc256c9a8c4fee42ea31f06a
Chain: n/a
Tx: [not anchored]
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Do this online before the 90-minute class. Keep the existing course folder and installed Ollama from Level 1. You need your own supported Windows or Mac computer for independent practice. A partner/saved route helps you learn when a device is unavailable, but does not prove your device works.

Get ready

Where	Action	Expected result	Recovery
Your course root	Open the folder containing <code>pyproject.toml</code> ; run <code>uv sync --frozen</code>	The locked environment installs without a changed lockfile	Follow the shared Windows or Mac guide
Browser	New local users open Ollama download ; choose the installer for their OS	Ollama installed and open	Read the official Windows guide or Mac guide
Terminal	Run <code>ollama --version</code>	A version number	Open Ollama; reopen the terminal after installation
Terminal, online	Run <code>ollama pull gemma3:1b</code>	Small model finishes downloading	Make disk space or allow more time before class
Terminal, online	Run <code>ollama pull gemma3:4b</code>	Larger model finishes; Level 1 users may already have it	Do not try a larger model to fix a memory failure
Terminal	Run <code>ollama list</code>	Both exact names appear with sizes and IDs	Finish the missing download while online
Course root	Run <code>uv run --frozen zta prepare local-models</code> , then <code>uv run --frozen zta doctor local-models</code>	Private files prepared and two LOCAL model rows	See recovery below
Course root	Run <code>uv run --frozen zta offline local-models</code> while still connected for a setup rehearsal	One local answer and a receipt	Label this connected rehearsal, never offline proof

The small download is about 815 MB and the larger about 3.3 GB, checked 2026-09-06 on the official [1B model card](#) and [4B model card](#). Working memory needs extra space. 8 GB RAM for the small route and 16 GB for the larger route are planning targets, not tested minimums or speed promises. Keep at least 8 GB free disk for downloads and working space, more if your system needs it. Record your actual size/digest; tags can change.

These local downloads require no API key or paid generation. Model terms are separate from the course license; read the [Gemma terms](#). The course contains templates and prompts, not model weights. Reuse the downloaded models instead of bundling someone else's model folder into your fork.

Local connection check

Keep the default loopback address. The lab always calls `http://127.0.0.1:11434`, ignores proxy variables, refuses cloud metadata, and never follows HTTP redirects. It does not read the Level 1 provider configuration or use its API key. Do not select a cloud model or enable web search. Ollama's [FAQ](#) explains the default local bind and optional cloud-disable setting; do not replace existing settings blindly.

Check your own listener before class if you have changed Ollama networking. On Mac, run `lsof -nP -iTCP:11434 -sTCP:LISTEN`; on Windows PowerShell, run `Get-NetTCPConnection -LocalPort 11434 -State Listen`. Expect `127.0.0.1` (loopback); `0.0.0.0`, `*`, or a LAN address needs instructor help before class. Do not stop an unknown process. Doctor checks model availability, not the listener's bind or all system traffic.

Recovery

- **Cannot connect:** open Ollama; use the listener check to identify the service. Keep the terminal in the course root. Do not switch the endpoint to a public service.
- **Missing model:** reconnect intentionally and finish the exact download before restarting offline proof. The lab will not download on your behalf.
- **Slow or out of memory:** close your own unused applications, retry once, then use the supplied saved rows for the larger model. Label each row's source. Never claim those times came from your computer.
- **No installer or network:** use a previously working local installation. If absent, work through the saved packet. A USB file alone is not a tested cross-platform model installer; do not copy unknown model stores into your account.
- **Course command missing:** confirm the reviewed Level 3 checkout and rerun `uv sync --frozen` while online. Do not guess a branch or overwrite uncommitted work.
- **Interrupted benchmark:** keep the partial receipt, mark missing rows Not performed, stop the matching course model if needed, then start a new receipt. Do not edit a failed receipt into a success.
- **Cannot disconnect access links:** use the connected rehearsal or saved route and explain the missing observation. Never sever a remote or assistive session to earn a check mark.

Bring the downloaded files, charger, your private worksheet, and a copy of the saved packet. Do not download models during the timed lesson.